

How can a still image communicate narratives that remain deliberately unresolved?

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MethodArchiveContact

Conceptual photography seriesProjectMadam, in Eden, I'm AdamYear2023

Concept Development

Narrative Systems

Visual Communication

Interdisciplinary Storytelling

Interaction design

Context

Original Constraint

Tell the story of Adam and Eve using only close-up photographs of hands.

Photography is often used to document reality or illustrate a defined idea. *Madam, in Eden, I'm Adam* investigates another possibility: the carefully constructed image as an invitation to interpret.

Behind the story, ongoing gender equality. Based on a true story that happened recently in India, and posted before Women's Day, "Owning and using a digital device is a household decision decided by the man." "Only 31% women own mobile phones in India." Women now should take permission from their husbands to use their phones in order to prioritize house duties.

The project does not offer a single, definitive explanation. Instead, it creates relationships between bodies, gestures, environments, and symbols. The viewer enters the narrative through these relationships and must decide how they connect.

two hands + negative space

A tiny spatial gap can carry an entire narrative.

How can a still image communicate a narrative that remains deliberately unresolved?

The research explores symbolism, body language, visual semiotics, cinematic composition, narrative photography, and emotional perception.

Attention remains on relationships rather than representation. A gesture can imply tension without describing its cause. A colour can connect two images without confirming a chronology. Composition can direct the eye while leaving the meaning of what it finds unresolved.

Desire / Intervention / Reaching gesture

Titian — The Fall of Man / Adam and Eve

Concealment

Masaccio — The Expulsion from the Garden of Eden

Shame / Guilt

Adam hides his face. Eve hides her body.

Rubens — Adam and Eve

Gesture reinterpretation

Movement / Theatricality

Concept Development

This required a different measure of success: An image did not need to explain the story; it needed to hold enough visual and emotional information for a story to form in the viewer's mind. Ambiguity became intentional and structured rather than accidental.

The project evolved from producing visually striking photographs to constructing narrative ambiguity.

The photographs became open-ended communication devices—precise in their construction, but plural in their possible meanings.

2. Direct photography through composition, gesture, and atmosphere.
3. Produce images as parts of a connected sequence.
1. Develop a storyboard without closing the narrative.
4. Refine the visual language through post-production.

Process

Define the conceptual and emotional territory.

Sequence the final series to sustain interpretation.

Research

The Facts about Mobile Phone Use by Indian Women

Madam, in Eden, I'm Adam, Deified Madam 24/7

Creation-M

Ideal Garden

Rights

Creation-W

Design's

Satan

Original sin

Punishment

Punishment?

Expulsion

Burn up

Creation

Every photograph functions as part of a larger narrative structure.

Meaning emerges through:

- composition;
- gesture;
- colour;
- sequencing; and
- symbolic relationships.

Each device carries information, but none provides a complete answer. The sequence creates continuity while preserving uncertainty, allowing viewers to construct different readings from the same visual evidence.

The series communicates through interpretation rather than explanation.

Outcome

The project materialises as a conceptual photography series, a cinematic image language, a narrative sequence, a visual storytelling system, and a consistent approach to post-production.

The final work is experienced both image by image and as a connected whole. Repetition and contrast create relationships across the series without fixing them into a single storyline.

Thus, >>

Reflection

This project strengthened my belief that images become most meaningful when they leave room for interpretation.

Communication does not always require complete clarity. Sometimes it requires carefully designed ambiguity: enough structure to invite attention, and enough openness for the viewer to participate in making meaning.